

# Daily Bible Note

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Date: 2026-06-12

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## I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 15:1-11

1 Moreover, brethren, I declare to you the gospel which I preached to you, which also you received and in which you stand,

2 by which also you are saved, if you hold fast that word which I preached to you—unless you believed in vain.

3 For I delivered to you first of all that which I also received: that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures,

4 and that He was buried, and that He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures,

5 and that He was seen by Cephas, then by the twelve.

6 After that He was seen by over five hundred brethren at once, of whom the greater part remain to the present, but some have fallen asleep.

7 After that He was seen by James, then by all the apostles.

8 Then last of all He was seen by me also, as by one born out of due time.

9 For I am the least of the apostles, who am not worthy to be called an apostle, because I persecuted the church of God.

10 But by the grace of God I am what I am, and His grace toward me was not in vain; but I labored more abundantly than they all, yet not I, but the grace of God which was with me.

11 Therefore, whether it was I or they, so we preach and so you believed.

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## II. Key Summary

- Paul states the core content of the gospel: Christ died for our sins according to the

Scriptures, was buried, and rose on the third day according to the Scriptures.

- Paul lists the witnesses of Christ's post-resurrection appearances: Cephas, the twelve, over five hundred brethren (most still living at the time of writing), James, all the apostles, and finally Paul himself.
  - Paul calls himself "the least of the apostles" and "not worthy to be called an apostle" because he once persecuted the church, and credits everything he became entirely to the grace of God working in him.
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### III. Passage Analysis

#### The Gospel Is Fact, Not Opinion

"The historical fact of Christ's death for our sins, His burial, His resurrection — this was the first Creed of Christendom." [1]

Paul is not offering a philosophical argument — he is presenting evidence. Christ died (witnessed), was buried (verifiable), and rose on the third day (seen by more than five hundred people). Paul even notes that most of those five hundred witnesses were still alive when he wrote this, meaning his readers could go ask them directly. The gospel doesn't rest on feelings or religious tradition; it rests on what actually happened in history.

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#### Grace Can Change Anyone — Even the Least Worthy

"Paul gave the grace of God all the credit for the change in his life. He was a changed man, forgiven, cleansed, and full of love when he used to be full of hate. He knew this was not his own accomplishment, but the work of the grace of God in him." [2]

Paul had hunted down Christians, stood by as they were killed, and believed he was doing the right thing. Yet he became one of the most tireless messengers of the faith in history. He doesn't credit his willpower or his growth — he says plainly, "by the grace of God I am what I am." No past is too dark for grace to reach.

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### IV. Reflection Question

Do you actually believe Jesus rose from the dead — and where does your answer come from? Is it something you were told, or something you've worked out for yourself?

Paul names Cephas, the twelve, over five hundred people, James, and finally himself — and notes most of them were still alive when he wrote this. His point is simple: this isn't legend. People saw it.

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## References

- [1] BibleHub.com, Ellicott's Commentary,  
[https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1\\_corinthians/15-3.htm](https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/15-3.htm)
- [2] Enduring Word, David Guzik,  
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-15/>